

Σημωνίδης ὁ Ἀμοργῖνος

Semonides of Amorgos on Human Folly

eul_aid: agy

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Ἰωνική [Ionic \(ia, frg\)](#)
Domain: Ποίσις [Poetry](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Semonides of Amorgos was an iambic poet of the 7th century BCE. Ancient sources report he led a colony from Samos to the island of Amorgos, founding three cities there, which indicates a figure of public stature. He was a near-contemporary of Archilochus and is often confused with the later lyric poet Simonides of Ceos.

His surviving work is fragmentary, derived from two books of iambic poetry. The most substantial fragment is a 118-line iambic poem cataloging ten types of women, comparing them to animals and elements like the pig, fox, sea, and bee. He is also credited with elegies, though only scant lines remain.

Semonides is a key figure in early Greek iambic poetry, a genre of satire and invective. His extended fragment on women is a major artifact of archaic Greek misogynistic thought and poetic cataloging, offering insight into contemporary social attitudes. His work was preserved in Alexandria and influenced later satirical literature.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · [On the Uncertainty of Human Life](#) · 128 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 2 passages